tehsil [sub-division] manager, a blanket, a jacket, and boots as well as money for their return trip home. Local managers were directed to apprise all prospective trainees of ‘issues such as the situation at training centers, likely difficulties, the need for patience and fortitude, and the motivation for jihad.’ Lashkar made clear to its recruiters that they should not refer ‘biased activists from other organizations’ for training. Once trainees completed the Daura-e-Aama and had returned home, local managers were instructed to keep them under surveillance so that they ‘do not deviate from the right path.’[35]

To promote its missionary and reformist objectives, the organization created teams at the zonal, district, and divisional levels to proselytize. However, these were deemed insufficient, and in 1998 ‘it was decided that a short twenty-one day program called Daura-e-Suffa would be implemented to invite people to Islam.’ The first such session was launched on 15 August under the supervision of Jamiat-ul-Dawa-al-Islamiyah [Institute for the Invitation to Islam] at Muridke to give students a crash course in dawa.[36] In short, the group began training an army of preachers. This new training was designed to cover Khitaab [oratory or readings of the Quran], information about the Hadith, Tarjumah [translation of the Quran], Salaat [prayers], Adhkar [remembrance] and calligraphy. The training session lasted fifteen days at Muridke after which participants were sent for a week of hands-on proselytizing to invite people to (Lashkar’s interpretation of Ahl-e-Hadith) Islam. Preaching was carried out in places such as markets, bazaars, bus and railway stations, parks, hospitals, police stations and courts.[37]

To attend the Daura-e-Suffa potential trainees first had to complete the Daura-e-Aama and then obtain a letter of recommendation from their district or tehsil manager. They were instructed to arrive at Muridke at the end of each month, at which time all attendees were required to deposit money and other valuables at the Dar-ul-Amanat [Office for Safekeeping]. Participants were tested to determine their level of religious knowledge and advised to prepare in advance by studying a syllabus provided to them.[38] Local managers were requested to train illiterate participants in the syllabus in advance and not send anyone who had not completed the Daura-e-Aama unless they were educated and highly motivated. Once again, managers